

CAREER PATHS

College professors must be experts in their field. They need not have any formal teaching qualifications; however, some colleges do prefer candidates who have some teaching experience. Progress is related to your academic profile—which is formed in part by the quality of your published research—and your networking skills.

GRADUATE One route is to obtain a graduate degree in a subject for which you have a passion. You will likely obtain some teaching experience along the way.

INDUSTRY PROFESSIONAL A good academic background plus work experience in a particular industry will help you find posts in subject areas such as finance or business studies.



DOCTORAL CANDIDATE PhD programs can take up to six years to complete, and include writing a dissertation, or a paper that details your research. You may be paid to teach undergraduates while working toward your PhD.



ASSISTANT PROFESSOR Delivers lectures and seminars while doing original research and publishing papers to raise their profile. May take on departmental tasks.



ASSOCIATE PROFESSOR Commonly a tenured position. Teaches classes and does scholarly work for publication in academic journals. Has an expanded role in the department.



PROFESSOR Leads the research culture of their department's faculty and focuses primarily on their scholarly activities.



DEAN Directs an institution's teaching and research, funding, and administration. The dean is the head of the college or university, with the position equivalent to being the director of a company.

SKILLS GUIDE



In-depth knowledge and proficiency in a chosen area of expertise.



Excellent communication skills for delivering lectures to students and colleagues.



Well-developed leadership and management skills to direct a research team.



Good organization skills to juggle teaching responsibilities, administrative tasks, and research.



High level of perseverance and dedication to complete research projects to a publishable standard.